

HYDERABAD | House Call

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For the first time after being elected to the Lok Sabha in 2009, Kalvakuntla Chandrashekhara Rao, the founder chief of the Telangana Rashtra Samithi (TRS), turned up at the Lok Sabha on April 19. His appearance was not for political compulsions. He was there to mark his attendance in order not to lose monetary benefits like travel allowances and other perks. Rao's partymen justified his absence from Parliament with the Telangana agitation and the time needed to present the case for a separate state to the Justice Srikrishna committee. Even as a minister in UPA-I, Rao was seldom seen in the Lok Sabha except when needed to answer questions pertaining to his ministry. Following her leader, actor-turned-politician Vijayashanti, the only other TRS MP, has also been staying away from the House.

by Amarnath K. Menon

PATNA | Law and Disorder

BIHAR MAY HAVE HIGH CRIME CONVICTION NUMBERS BUT THEY ARE NOT MUCH OF A DETERRENT.

Once again, Bihar's law and order is in the news, this time for the lack of tourist security there. A Japanese tourist in her mid-twenties was gangraped on April 16 by two autodrivers and three others in Bodh Gaya, the revered destination of Buddhist pilgrims from across the world. The incident took place at a time when footfalls of foreign tourists have gone up by nearly four times in Bihar during the last three years. The police have arrested three persons in the case while two are on the run. Bihar has made a mark with the conviction of over 44,000 criminals in the last four years, but it has not had the requisite effect.

by Amitabh Srivastava

MUMBAI | Clean Swipe

The Maharashtra Government has hit upon an idea to combat the menace of fake degree rackets. This June onwards, marksheets and degree certificates will be given to graduating students as swipe cards at subsidised rates. Over 1,134 cases of fake degrees were reported in the state since February this year. The Government will set up kiosks in colleges, some banks and offices. Private employers can either get the machine installed from the Government or access the degrees online.

by Mitali Patel

WHAT THEY DON'T TEACH YOU AT STANFORD, MANAGEMENT GURU PRAHALAD DID.

OBITUARY C.K. PRAHALAD 1941-2010

He was the master to India's top CEOs. Coimbatore Krishnarao Prahalad excelled not only in contributing to fundamental business concepts such as strategic intent, but was also instrumental in changing the mindset of policymakers and industry. The seeds of what is now hyped as inclusive growth were sown by Prahalad's research. His vision in *Power at the Bottom of the Pyramid* may well be the beacon for policymakers and government. The management guru who could never stop creating and thinking, Prahalad will be remembered as the man who gave Indians the confidence to compete as equals on the global stage. CKP, as he was called, was clear that new products will have to be innovative as well as environmentally friendly and that future consumers will insist on both these attributes in their products.

by Nivedita Mukherjee

